PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (PRD-LITE)

Real Passport & Community Boards

Prepared for: Product Leadership Review
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Prototype: Interactive clickable prototype attached separately

1. Executive Summary

Real Passport & Community Boards introduces optional, time-boxed community boards that give users an additional reason to open BeReal beyond their single daily photo. When a user posts, they may choose to tag that same, unedited photo to a themed board (e.g. “College Campus” or “Coffee Shop”). Doing so earns a lightweight “passport stamp” and adds their photo to a shared visual capsule with friends who also opted in.

The goal is to increase Monthly Active Users (MAU) and daily engagement without changing what makes BeReal different: one real, spontaneous photo, no filters, no pressure. Nothing about the core capture mechanic changes, and every part of this feature is opt-in.

2. Problem Statement

Research from our competitor benchmarking and user feedback surfaced three recurring pain points:

- Users often post once and forget to return — the feed goes quiet for the rest of the day.
- The one-photo format can start to feel repetitive over time, with no sense of shared occasion or ritual.
- There is no lightweight way for a friend group to rally around a shared moment without creating a group chat or event.

3. Feature Overview

The feature has five core pieces:

- Daily Theme Prompt — a new prompt unlocks at 12:00am in the user's local timezone (e.g. “Take notes or take naps? Show us your study spot”), giving people a reason to open the app to see what's live.
- Opt-in Board Tagging — at capture time, users choose “Theme Post” (tag today's post to a board) or “Random Post” (unchanged, untagged posting).
- Theme Boards — a rotating set of boards each month (e.g. College Campus, Brunch & Tea Time, Coffee Shop, Best Book/Music), each with a distinct name, tagline, and visual identity.
- Capsule Carousel — tagged photos from opted-in friends collect into a shared, collage-style capsule for that board; friends can heart and comment.
- Passport & Leaderboard — a personal grid of stamps earned, and a friend-group leaderboard ranking participation.

A board stays open for its assigned month, then locks as a read-only memory capsule — it becomes a keepsake, not an ongoing treadmill.

4. Why This Stays True to BeReal's Values

Value	How the feature honors it
Authentic	The underlying post is identical to today's BeReal — no new content requirement, no filters, no retakes.
Opt-in, not mandatory	Random/untagged posting remains fully supported; nothing changes for users who ignore boards.
Light, not addictive	Stamps and leaderboard reward participation positively; there is no streak-loss or shame messaging.
Time-boxed	Boards close at month end and become an archive, not an infinite grind.

5. Goals & Success Metrics

Primary goal: increase MAU and daily engagement while preserving authenticity.

- North Star: DAU/MAU ratio (stickiness)
- Daily open rate (sessions per user per day)
- D7 and D30 retention
- % of daily posts tagged to a board (feature adoption)
- Passport / Leaderboard visit frequency (secondary engagement signal)
- Qualitative: user sentiment on whether the feature still “feels like BeReal”

6. Target Users

Full persona detail lives in the companion Case Study & User Journey document. In summary:

- Prompt-Chaser Priya — highly social, motivated by daily themes and light competition.
- Casual Real Carter — small friend circle, wary of gamification, needs opt-in fully respected.
- Community Connector Maya — uses shared boards to rally her friend group around a moment.

7. Key Requirements

7.1 Daily Prompt Engine

- Compute “today's theme” per user's local timezone; unlock at local midnight.
- Single, capped, dismissible nudge when the prompt unlocks — no repeated badgering.
- The prompt engine must resolve which board(s) are live on a given day — flagship boards run all month, but shorter-run boards (a single day or a week) can be active in parallel; see 7.3.

7.2 Capture Flow

- Add a “Theme Post / Random Post” toggle to the existing capture screen; default state is neutral (no auto opt-in).
- If Theme Post: user selects one active board; the post is tagged, added to that board's capsule, and stamped.

7.3 Community Boards

- Each board has a configurable duration — Month (flagship), Week, or Day — set at creation. Multiple durations can run concurrently within the same month.

- Up to four flagship (month-long) boards run per month, each with a name, tagline, and distinct visual pattern/color.
- Shorter-run boards (single-day or single-week) layer on top of the flagship boards for observances, awareness days, or recurring weekly rituals.
- Boards lock when their duration ends; locked boards are browsable but accept no new posts.

October example — flagship boards run all month; shorter observance boards run alongside them on their relevant day(s):

Board	Duration	Example tagline
College Campus	Month	Main character or campus goblin?
Brunch & Tea Time	Month	Sippin' tea, spillin' tea
Coffee Shop	Month	Powered by iced coffee & delusion
Best Book/Music	Month	Currently in my main-character soundtrack era
Halloween	Day	It's giving spooky szn
Cramming for Exams	Week	Locked in (or locked out)
Breast Cancer Awareness	Week	Pink out for a cause 🎗
Help a Neighbor Day	Day	Community era activated
Doodles & Noodles	Day	Feed me and let me draw
Wednesday Winedown	Weekly recurring	No thoughts, just vibes and a glass

7.4 Social Interaction (MVP)

- Friends can heart and comment on capsule photos, reusing the existing comment and moderation stack.
- Shipped in the Phase 1 MVP, not deferred — interaction is core to making a capsule feel like a shared moment rather than a static gallery.

7.5 Passport & Leaderboard (MVP)

- Passport: personal grid of stamps earned, with locked/greyed entries for boards not joined or already archived.
- Leaderboard: ranks friends within the existing friend graph by points (e.g. +10 per stamped post); refreshes nightly.
- A lightweight version of both ships in Phase 1 MVP alongside a single board, so the full loop — post, stamp, browse, vote, comment, rank — can be tested end to end from day one.

7.6 Sponsorship Hook (V2, not MVP)

- Data model reserves an optional sponsor field per board (name, logo, tagline) for a future monetization pilot; no ad-serving logic ships in V1.

8. Non-Goals / Out of Scope for MVP

- No paid sponsorships or ad-serving in V1 — data model support only.
- No public, cross-friend-group leaderboard — stays within each user's existing friend graph.
- No changes to the core once-daily BeReal notification or capture mechanic.
- No new moderation model beyond what already exists for comments.

9. Prioritization (RICE)

Indicative scoring for roadmap discussion — to be refined with real usage data after the prototype test.

Factor	Rating	Rationale
Reach	High	Daily prompt is visible to any user who opens the app; broad exposure across the base.
Impact	Medium-High	Adds a new, repeatable engagement loop without touching the core photo mechanic.
Confidence	Medium	Directional MAU hypothesis; not yet validated with real users beyond the clickable prototype.
Effort	Medium	Front-end heavy (prompt UI, capture toggle, board/capsule/leaderboard screens); backend needs timezone-aware scheduling, a board/stamp data model, and support for configurable board durations (day/week/month).

10. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Gamification feels performative or off-brand	Keep stamps invisible unless opted in; never surface “you didn't post today” shame messaging.
Notification fatigue from the daily prompt	One capped, dismissible nudge; user can disable in settings.
Increased moderation load from board comments	Reuse the existing moderation and reporting pipeline; no new system required.
Low adoption of opt-in tagging	Use soft social proof (“12 friends posted to Coffee Shop today”) rather than penalizing non-participants.

11. Rollout Plan

- Phase 0 (complete): interactive clickable prototype for internal review and qualitative testing.
- Phase 1 (MVP): ship one flagship board with the full loop — theme prompt, opt-in tagging, capsule, voting/comments, Passport, and Leaderboard — to a limited test cohort; measure adoption and DAU/MAU lift before further investment.
- Phase 2: expand breadth — four concurrent flagship boards plus shorter day/week observance boards running in parallel (see 7.3 October example).
- Phase 3: pilot sponsor-branded boards as a monetization test, subject to brand-safety review.

12. Prototype Reference

An interactive HTML prototype demonstrating all core screens — Today, Boards, Board Detail, Capture, Passport, and Leaderboard — is included as a companion deliverable for hands-on review.

13. Design Assets Checklist

Production assets design will need to create or supply, separate from engineering work:

- Board background art — a distinct visual pattern/illustration per board (flagship and short-run), used behind the photo collage.
- Passport stamp — the stamp graphic applied to a tagged post, plus a per-board variant (e.g. a campus-themed stamp vs. a coffee-themed stamp).
- Passport screen — the personal stamp-collection grid, including a locked/greyed state for boards not yet joined or already archived.
- Leaderboard — rank list styling, including treatment for top ranks vs. standard rows.
- Capsule carousel — a compelling, browsable way to move between current and archived boards (e.g. swipeable capsule cards), for both the live board feed and the past-boards gallery.

14. Ask

We are requesting approval to run a limited Phase 1 test (one friend-group cohort, one flagship board, full feature loop) to validate the MAU hypothesis before committing further engineering investment.